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விவசாயத் திணைக்களம்
Department of Agriculture

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Nursery methods – Parachute Nursery

Nursery

Nursery location

- Established in parachute trays with dimensions of 56 x 34 x 2 cm (length x width x height).
    - one tray consists of 434 small holes.
    - nearly 760-765 trays are required for 1 ha.
- On a flat land exposed to sufficient sunlight.
    - Can be established as a **dry-bed** or a **wet-bed** nursery.
    - should have accessibility to a water supply.

Construction of the seed bed

- Holes of the trays are filled up to about ¾ height with clay.
- Trays are placed as rows of two trays.
- If **wet-bed** method is used, a part of the field is used to place trays.
    - should be about 10cm high and 75cm wide
    - have an appropriate length to accommodate all trays.
    - should be kept for 1-2 days before the trays are placed.

Nursery maintenance

- Trays are covered with coconut or banana leaves to provide protection from rain and desiccation.
    - removed after 2-3 days.

    - water is added if required.

Seed paddy

Requirement

- About 20-30 kg/ha
- Assures the advantage of less cost for seed paddy and labor.

Seed Preparation

- Soaked for 24 hours and incubated for 24 hours.
- Or dry seeds.

Nursery establishment

- Pre-germinated or dry seeds are placed on holes (2-3 seeds per hole).
- A thin layer of soil is spread over the seeds.
- Water is added as required.

- Seedlings are removed from trays **after 12 days**.
    - Along with the mud balls
    - and thrown over the field evenly.

This method will avoid transplanting shock. and therefore, suitable for varieties of all age groups. However, feasible only with smaller fields (less than 2 acres).